

- **Low:** The lowest price the stock reaches during the trading session
- **Close:** The final price when trading ends for the session
- **Volume:** The number of shares traded during the session

This collection of data points is often abbreviated as OHLCV (Open, High, Low, Close, Volume) and represents the standard format for tracking price movements.

Here's what a simple dataset of daily stock prices might look like:

Date	Open	High	Low	Close	Volume
2023-07-03	193.78	196.47	193.37	193.97	30,461,200
2023-07-05	193.50	194.33	191.64	191.94	27,347,300
2023-07-06	191.41	192.02	189.97	190.68	25,111,200

Each row represents one trading day, with columns showing the key price data points and trading volume. This seemingly simple data contains a wealth of information that algorithms can analyze to identify patterns and make trading decisions.

*?? **Did You Know?** The New York Stock Exchange (NYSE) processes approximately 3 terabytes of market data every day. That's equivalent to about 300,000 copies of the complete works of Shakespeare—created and processed daily! This flood of data isn't just stock prices, but includes every order, cancellation, and trade modification. Modern trading firms like Citadel Securities and Virtu Financial build massive data processing systems just to capture, store, and analyze this information, giving them a competitive edge in algorithmic trading.*

Market Indices: The Big Picture

Market indices provide a broader view of market movements by tracking groups of stocks. Major indices like the S&P 500, Dow Jones Industrial Average, and NASDAQ Composite serve as barometers for different segments of the market.